Chromatic Aberration , and is caused when the different colours of light take different paths after passing through the lens. To understand this better, let's turn to a simple concept we all first encountered in school...

We all know that when white light passes through a prism, it breaks up into its constituent colours. This is because different wavelengths of light bend at different angles when they pass through another medium—in this case, glass. The same thing happens when light passes through a lens. In cameras, manufacturers avoid this by using compound lenses, which compensate for the dispersion of light and bring the component wavelengths back together. Unfortunately, things could go wrong sometimes, and you can find yourself looking at a photo with a bluish fringe along the edges of objects.

This is where the Lens Corrections Tab comes in: the two sliders under Chromatic Aberration let you correct any fringing you may see in your photo. In addition, you can use the Lens Vignetting slider to create a dark or light area at the edges of your image to focus on the centre, or eliminate that effect if your camera has caused it and you don't want it.

The Camera Calibration Tab

Under this tab, you can tweak the colour settings for your camera using the Hue and Saturation slider for the red, green and blue colour channels. When you're satisfied with the result and want to use your new settings for every photo taken by the same camera, click on the small icon on the top-right of the tab and choose Save New Camera Raw Defaults.

The Straighten Tool

If you shot your photo a little crooked, you can fix its orientation using the straighten tool—it's the sixth from the left on the main toolbar. Just click and drag along what should be the straight edge of your photo, and you'll get a box that shows you the area that'll represent your final photo. Depending on how crooked the